

ABC RESTAURANT

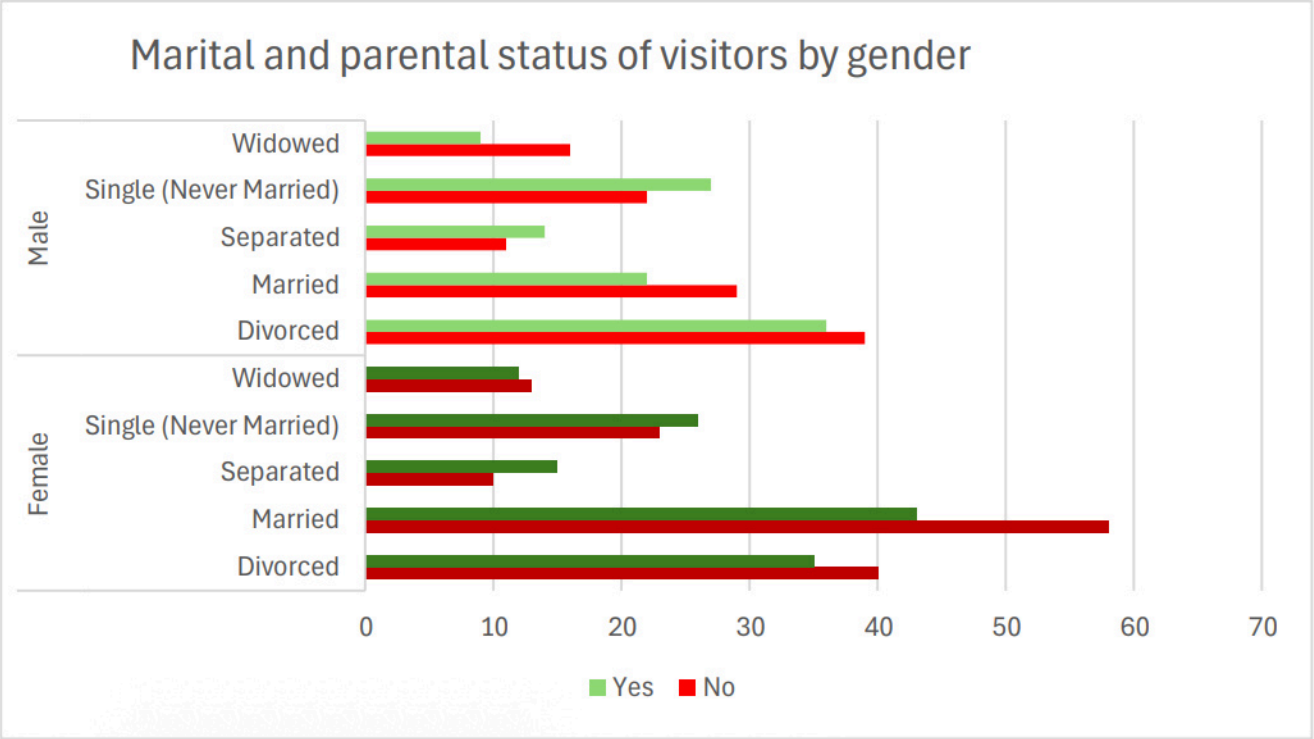
How a lucrative business can fall short

Questionnaires and Reviews give consumer insights on what consumers really think. What changes in operations can save the business?

QUESTION 1A

Based on the number of restaurant visits in the prior year, which gender had the highest number of visits? Within that gender, which marital status had the most visits to the restaurant in the previous year? Within that marital status, did most of them have children or no children?

Count of #VisitsPriorYear		Children		
Gender	Marital Statu	No	Yes	Grand Total
Female	Divorced	40	35	75
	Married	58	43	101
	Separated	10	15	25
	Single (Neve	23	26	49
	Widowed	13	12	25
Female Total		**144**	**131**	**275**
Male	Divorced	39	36	75
	Married	29	22	51
	Separated	11	14	25
	Single (Neve	22	27	49
	Widowed	16	9	25
Male Total		**117**	**108**	**225**
Grand Total		**261**	**239**	**500**



- Based on the visits the prior year, **Females** had the **highest number** of **visits**. Within that field, most of the females who visited were **married with no children**.

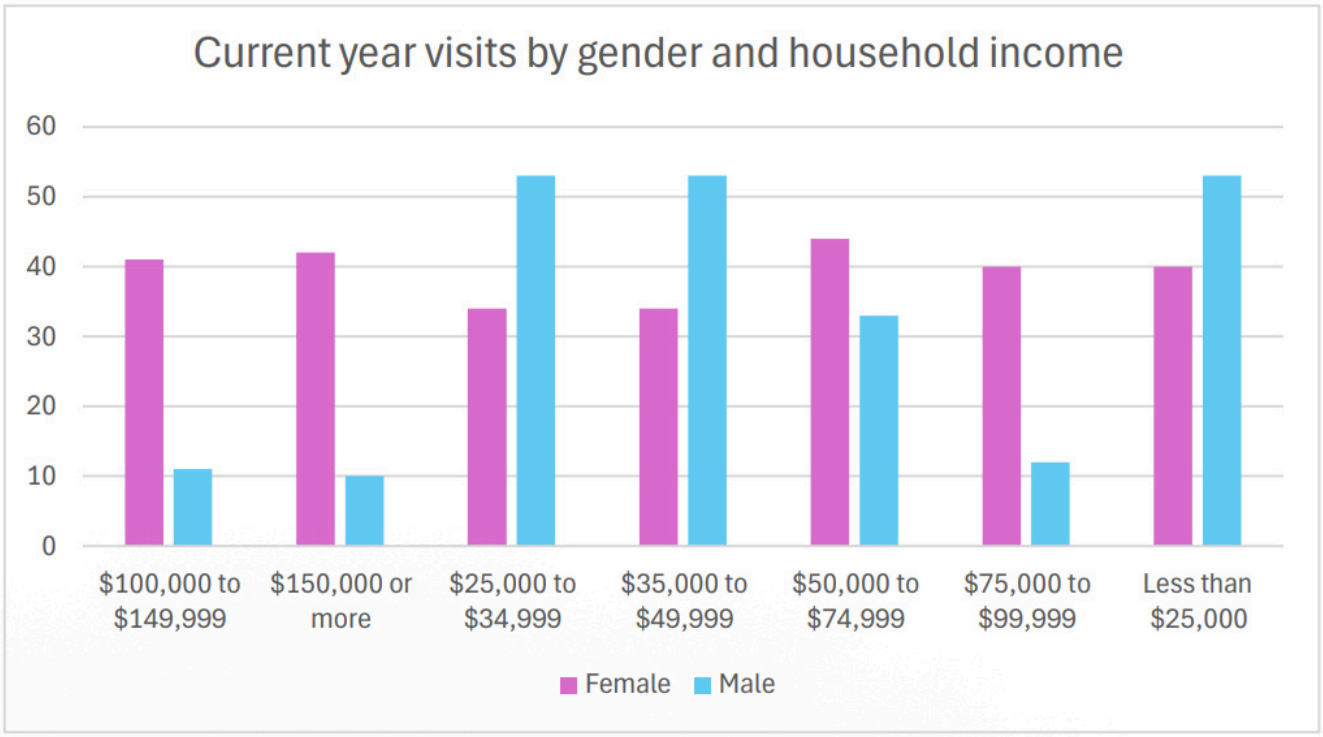
How might this impact your recommendations for helping the restaurant increase sales/revenue?

- This data **impacts** the recommended marketing **strategies for increasing sales and revenue for the restaurant**. Since **women represent the largest and most engaged customer group**, marketing **efforts** should be **strategically tailored to attract and retain female diners**. **Campaigns** should **highlight upscale, experience-driven offerings** that **appeal** to **women**, such as **"ladies' night" events, wine or specialty beverage discounts, brunch promotions, and dine-in specials**. The restaurant's **atmosphere** should be thoughtfully designed to appeal to women without children—favoring a **calm, sophisticated environment** over a family-oriented one. As a result, the menu does not need to focus heavily on child-friendly options and can instead **emphasize adult-oriented selections**, including a wider variety of **premium and specialty beverages**. By aligning both the ambiance and offerings with the preferences of this key demographic, the restaurant can drive stronger engagement, higher spending, and increased repeat visits (Coussement, 1999, Discussion).

QUESTION 1B

What was the household income of females and males with the most visits in the current year?

Count of #VisitsCurrentYear	Gender		
Total Household Income	Female	Male	Grand Total
$100,000 to $149,999	41	11	52
$150,000 or more	42	10	52
$25,000 to $34,999	34	53	87
$35,000 to $49,999	34	53	87
$50,000 to $74,999	44	33	77
$75,000 to $99,999	40	12	52
Less than $25,000	40	53	93
Grand Total	**275**	**225**	**500**



- **Females** with the most visits had a household income of **$50,000-$74,999**. **Males ranged** from **less than $25,000**, **$25,000-$34,999**, and **$35,999-$49,999**.

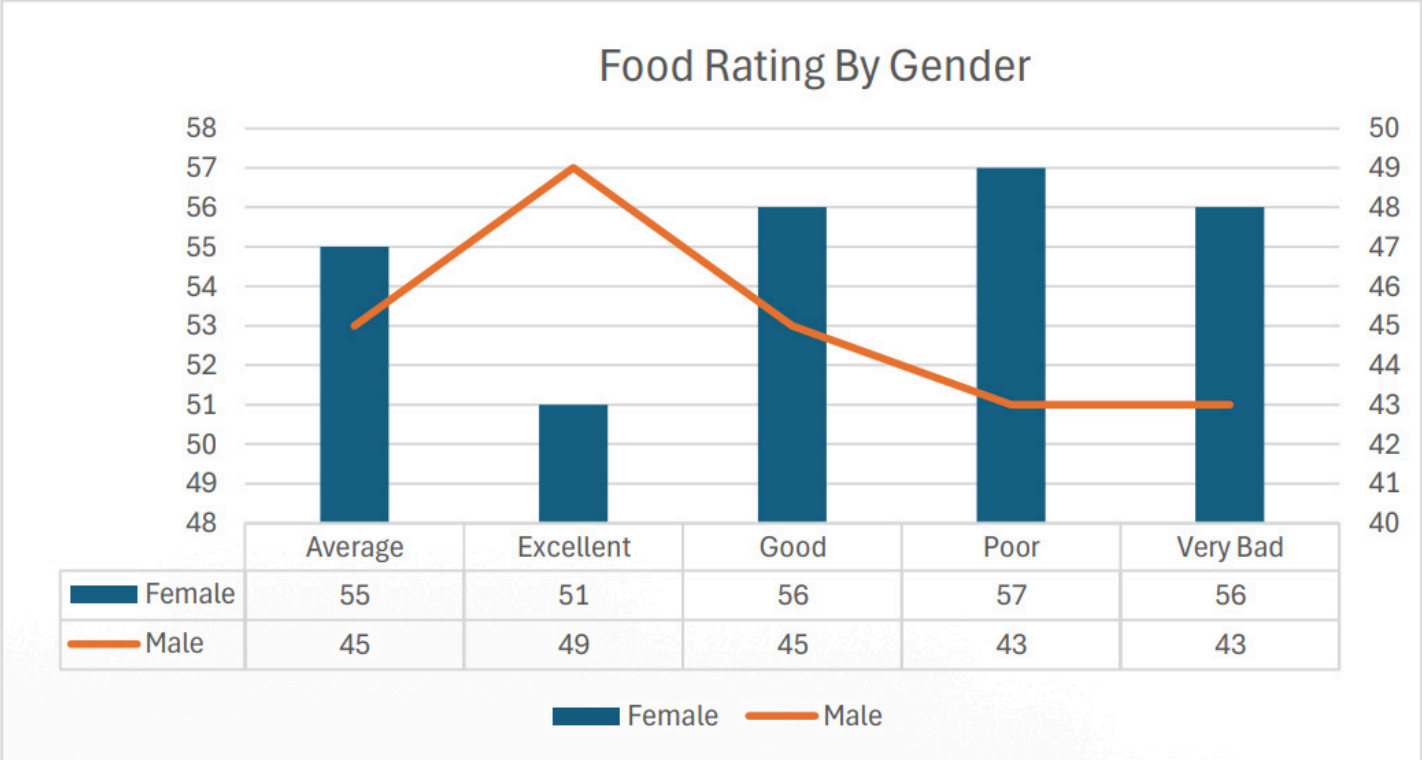
How might this information impact your recommendations for increasing sales/revenue for the restaurant?

- This information highlights the importance of designing gender-sensitive pricing and promotional strategies to increase restaurant sales and revenue. Since **female customers** are more likely to **spend more** and **prioritize quality**, the restaurant should **focus on premium** menu **items**, **elegant plating**, and **upscale dining experiences**. Small price increases on high-quality offerings may be well accepted by this group, especially when **bundled with value-added elements** like **wine pairings** or **chef-curated specials**. For **male customers**, who tend to be **more price-conscious** and **value-driven**, strategies should **emphasize affordability and savings**, such as **combo deals**, **happy hour pricing, or loyalty rewards**. Discount offers like **"buy one, get one"** or **budget meal bundles** are likely to **appeal to this group** and can help boost traffic during off-peak hours. **By differentiating tactics based on spending behavior, the restaurant can maximize revenue from high-spending customers while attracting volume from more budget-sensitive diners**.

QUESTION 1C

What is the breakdown of responses for satisfaction with the food?

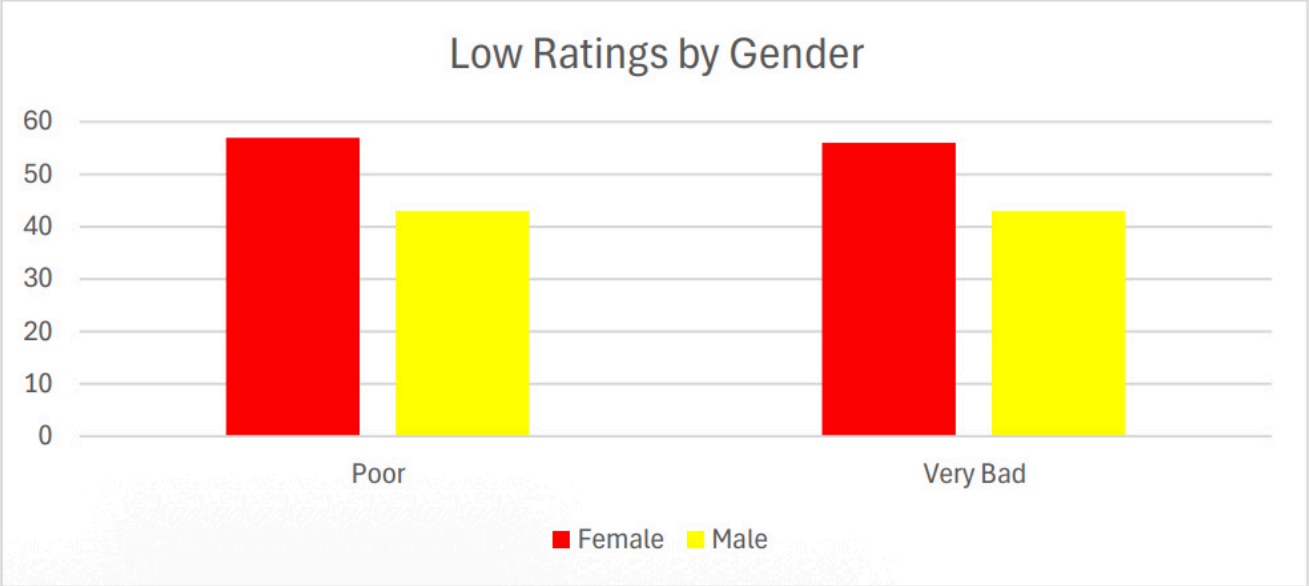
Count of FoodRate	Gender		
FoodRate	Female	Male	Grand Total
Average	55	45	100
Excellent	51	49	100
Good	56	45	101
Poor	57	43	100
Very Bad	56	43	99
Grand Total	**275**	**225**	**500**



- The responses for satisfaction with the food show that **female respondents consistently provided more feedback across all satisfaction levels compared to males**. **Within** the **total** number of **responses**, the **amount is relatively balanced** across all satisfaction levels **between both genders**. Each category received close to 100 total responses, suggesting balanced engagement across the scale. The most **common rating** overall was "**Good**," with a total of 101 responses, indicating that this was the predominant experience among diners. Notably, even in the negative satisfaction categories such as "Poor" and "Very Bad," the number of female responses remained higher, which may reflect a greater level of engagement or willingness among women to share their dining experiences. Given the volume of lower satisfaction ratings, particularly in the "Poor" and "Very Bad" categories, **adjustments** to **menu options**, **food quality**, and **plating** should be **prioritized**. Enhancing the **taste** and **visual appeal** of dishes is **essential**, as **food that looks vibrant, smells appetizing, and delivers rich, balanced flavors is more likely to leave a lasting impression**. Diners are drawn to meals that engage multiple senses—**visually striking presentations, enticing aromas, satisfying textures, and bold, memorable flavors** (Randhir & Latasha ,2016, as cited in Goswami et al., 2024). When these elements are thoughtfully executed, they create a more immersive and enjoyable dining experience, encouraging guests to return and share their positive experiences with others, ultimately driving both customer loyalty and revenue growth.

Of those responding Poor or Very Bad, what is the gender breakdown?

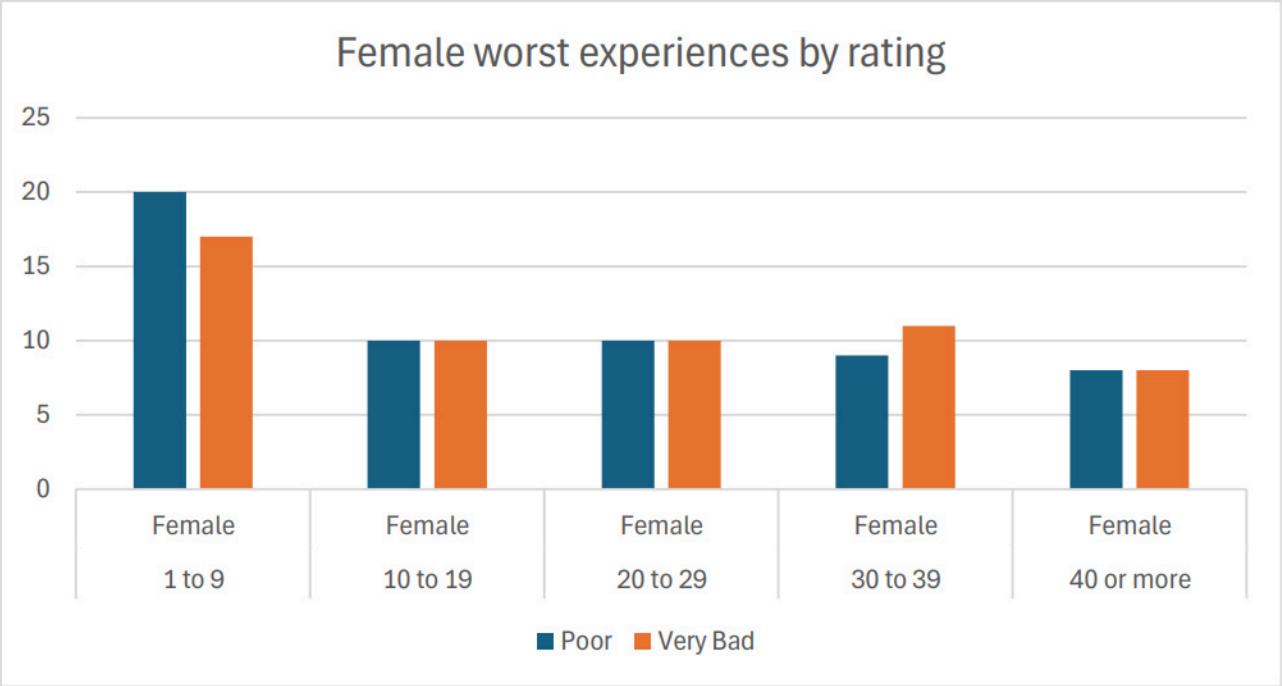
Count of Recommend FoodRate	Gender Female	Male	Grand Total
Poor	57	43	100
Very Bad	56	43	99
Grand Total	**113**	**86**	**199**



- The data shows that among those who rated their food experience as "Poor" or "Very Bad," a greater number were female respondents—113 compared to 86 male respondents. This indicates that not only are **women more likely to provide feedback**, but they are **also more likely to express dissatisfaction** with the food. This insight suggests a gap between the restaurant's offerings and the expectations of its **primary customer base**. Given that **women make** up the **majority** of diners, and tend to be **more engaged**, their dissatisfaction holds more weight. If their needs and preferences are not adequately addressed, the restaurant risks losing its most active and potentially highest-spending demographic. **Improving food quality, presentation, and consistency must be a top priority. Failing to respond to this feedback could lead to a decline in repeat visits, negative word-of-mouth, and lost revenue.** Consumption experience impacts consumers decision to return (Chen et al., 2014, 2. Literature Review).

Of the females that responded Poor or Very Bad, how many times did they visit in the current year?

Count of Recommend		FoodRate		
#VisitsCurrentYear	Gender	Poor	Very Bad	Grand Total
1 to 9	Female	20	17	37
1 to 9 Total		**20**	**17**	**37**
10 to 19	Female	10	10	20
10 to 19 Total		**10**	**10**	**20**
20 to 29	Female	10	10	20
20 to 29 Total		**10**	**10**	**20**
30 to 39	Female	9	11	20
30 to 39 Total		**9**	**11**	**20**
40 or more	Female	8	8	16
40 or more Total		**8**	**8**	**16**
Grand Total		**57**	**56**	**113**



- Of the **females** who **rated** their experience "**Poor**", they visited a total of **57 times**, while females who rated their experience as "**Very Bad**" visited a total of **56 times**. This brings the **total** number of **visits** at **113**.

Of those that responded Poor or Very Bad, how many would recommend the restaurant?

- Those that responded "**Poor**" and "**Very Bad**" were a **total** of **199**. The rating "**Poor**", being the **most selected between** the **two** by a point. As **both** of these **ratings have a high count**, it is **recommended** to **provide** a **follow-up survey** asking customers **for feedback** to gain clarity on responses. The **clarity responses** can **help** the **restaurant assess** what **feasible changes** they can make **to improve** the less than stellar **ratings**.

Based on the results and what you have learned in this course, what might you recommend to the restaurant that would help the owners achieve their goal to increase revenue?

- To **improve** the restaurant's **growth goals**, using **exploratory**, **descriptive**, and **explanatory research** is **essential**. **Exploratory** research would seek to **uncover** potential **opportunities or challenges** by gathering insights through methods such as **focus groups or interviews**. Conducting **interview**s with **frequent diners** could **reveal unmet needs or preferences**, like a desire for more vegan options. **Descriptive research** then **quantifies** these **findings** by studying market **demographics**, **customer behavior**, and **competitor offerings**. A **survey** could be distributed to **identify** the most **popular dishes** and **average** customer **spending**, **helping** the **restaurant benchmark** itself **against local competitors**. Finally, **explanatory research investigates cause-and-effect relationships**, such as **how** menu **pricing** changes **affect customer retention**. Running an **A/B test** with **two different price points** can **reveal which price** will **likely increase repeat business**. Together, **these research methods provide** a substantial **foundation** for making **informed decisions** that support **sustainable growth** (David, 2018, 3 The Research Agenda).

How might this information impact your recommendations for increasing sales/revenue for the restaurant?

- It will **provide data-driven insights** on customer **behavior**, unmet **preferences**, and **unmet needs**. **Knowing** of their unmet preferences **allows** the **restaurant** to **compare** their **store with** the **market and competition**. **Other benefits** include **identifying peak-business hours**, **staffing efficiency** and **ingredient preferences**. **Once changes** have been **made**, **research** will be created **again** to **test** the **effectiveness** of the changes (Albrecht et al., 2023b, 6.2 Sources of Marketing Information).



References

Albrecht, M. G., Green, M., & Hoffman, L. (2023b, January 25). *6.2 Sources of Marketing Information - Principles of Marketing | OpenStax*. https://openstax.org/books/principles-marketing/pages/6-2-sources-of-marketing-information

Chen, H.-B., Yeh, S.-S., & Huan, T.-C. (2014). Nostalgic emotion, experiential value, brand image, and consumption intentions of customers of nostalgic-themed restaurants. *Journal of Business Research*, *67*(3), 354–360. https://doi-org.ezproxy.umgc.edu/10.1016/j.jbusres.2013.01.003

Coussement, S. H. (1999). *Food presentation as a communication: The effects of presentation style and restaurant ambiance on food preference and expectations for the dining experience* (Order No. 9966930). Available from ProQuest Dissertations & Theses Global. (304500615). http://ezproxy.umgc.edu/login?url=https://www.proquest.com/dissertations-theses/food-presentation-as-communication-effects-style/docview/304500615/se-2

David J. Smith. (2018). *Marketing Research for Small Business: An Efficient and Effective Functional Approach*. Nova.

Goswami, S., Malakar, D., & Ahmed, S. (2024). Role of Scented Ambience in Shaping Consumer Behaviour. *Srusti Management Review, 17*(2), 102-119. http://ezproxy.umgc.edu/login?url=https://www.proquest.com/scholarly-journals/role-scented-ambience-shaping-consumer-behaviour/docview/3161970558/se-2

Link to Survey Data: ABC Restaurant Survey Data 1.xlsx